



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Coram Deo Classical School
School Website: <https://coramdeoclassical.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Coram Deo Classical School (CDCS) in Peachtree City, GA (Zip 30269) presents a robust classical Christian program with strong religious foundations, a formation-focused purpose, and a curriculum centered on liberal arts, Great Books, and a Trivium-based structure. Public materials from the school's site emphasize Christ-centered education, Scripture-informed pedagogy, liturgical and communal practices, and a clear commitment to truth, goodness, and beauty. The public materials also reveal a community-supported model that actively engages parents as partners and centers faculty as living exemplars of classical formation. Overall, the school aligns strongly with classical aims across most rubric categories, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing some nuances that merit a closer look, but not enough to undermine the overall classical orientation.

- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL
- Key strengths: explicit Christian/theological integration; trivium-based curriculum; great books and classical rhetoric emphasis; liturgical and communal practices; explicit parent partnership; living-faculty model present in public materials.
- The one category with relative nuance: Pedagogy (Element 4) shows substantial classical elements (memory work, chant, hymn-like practices, and structured recitation) but less explicit evidence of Socratic seminars or high school-level seminar culture in the public-facing materials. This yields a Somewhat Classical signal for that single category, while the others strongly align with classical aims.

Executive summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on evidence and keyword methodology are provided in the category sections below. Citations reference public-CDCS materials (web content) and the classical elements lexicon and rubric documents in the knowledge base.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials consistently frame CDCS as a classical Christian education, with explicit emphasis on Christ-centered formation and the Word of God. For example, the site states that Coram Deo Classical School offers a "Classical Christian Education for grades K-12" with transformation through encounter with the True, the Good, and the Beautiful, rooted in Scripture (e.g., "Classical Christian Education for grades K-12" and "the True, the Good, and the Beautiful"). - The school explicitly asserts that

“every subject at Coram Deo takes place before the face of God,” with Scripture dictating teaching across disciplines (e.g., “history is taught as God’s unfolding story,” “literature as windows to truth, goodness, and beauty”). - Public materials emphasize liturgical/community practices (daily prayer, catechisms, communal singing, monthly chapel) and a liturgical rhythm (e.g., catechisms, Scripture readings, and singing as part of daily life). - The school’s stated mission references transformation through a Christian framework—“transformative encounters with the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”—and a focus on worship, virtue, wisdom, and courage anchored in Scripture. - The “foundation” statements in the Why Classical Christian Education page explicitly frame education as non-neutral and religiously oriented, reinforcing a theologically grounded approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; God’s Word; Scripture; Bible; liturgy; chapel; catechesis; worship; true/good/beautiful; reverence; wonder; sacred tradition; Logos; virtue; moral realism; imago Dei. - Negative keywords present: None identified in the public materials (no explicit secular/relativist signals countering a theocentric stance). - Quantitative estimate: P approx. 9–12 distinct positive religious/metaphysical indicators appear across the materials; N approx. 0 explicit negative indicators. Interpretation: 100% positive in terms of the lexical signals present. Why this rating - The materials consistently demonstrate transcendental moral realism and a theologically grounded education, with explicit liturgical and communal practices, and a telos oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian frame. This strongly satisfies the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria. See evidence references above. The absence of explicit negative signals reinforces the Classical alignment in this category. ☐filecite☐turn0file1☐turn0file0☐turn0file4☐

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials articulate formation as the central goal, focusing on virtue and wisdom rather than job preparation. Portraits of the graduate emphasize becoming “fully alive in Christ through transformative encounters with the True, the Good, and the Beautiful,” i.e., formation over mere information. - The school’s stated mission emphasizes training hearts to worship rightly, souls to choose virtue, minds to pursue wisdom, and bodies to run with courage, all rooted in Scripture. This foregrounds virtue and humane excellence. - The foundation statements include the notion that education is formation (not simply information) and that truth, goodness, and beauty are knowable through the mind, aligning with classical formation aims. - The admissions; family and parental partnership language centers character formation and moral formation as core aims, not merely credentialing or job-readiness.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; telos; liberal education; true/good/beautiful; moral imagination; contemplation; human flourishing; soul craft; character; virtuous life; moral order; imago Dei. - Negative keywords present: The site does not emphasize “workforce preparation” or “career readiness” in a way that competes with formation; no explicit negative signals against formation are evident. - Quantitative estimate: P approx. 8–10 positive indicators; N approx. 0–1 subtle signals (none explicit countering formation). Interpretation: near 100% positive lexical signaling for formation-focused aims. Why this rating - The site consistently frames education as formation and a cultivation of virtue and wisdom, with a teleology toward the Good and Beautiful, not primarily toward job-readiness or technical/workforce outcomes. The presence of phrases like “transformative encounters with the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” and the emphasis on virtue and wisdom substantiate a Classical orientation for purpose/goals. ☐filecite☐turn0file1☐turn0file4☐

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program explicitly adapts the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across grades K–12, indicating a formal liberal-arts structure foundational to classical education. - The Upper School materials show engagement with Great Books and classical studies (e.g., “In the Upper School, students engage great books, logic, and theology ... pursuit of excellence, virtue, and Christ-centered scholarship”). This

aligns with Great Books and classical curriculum aims. - History is taught as “God’s unfolding story,” and literature is framed as windows to truth, goodness, and beauty, indicating a historically grounded and theologically informed curriculum. - The curriculum includes Latin/foreign language options and a Focus on logic, rhetoric, and composition (Rhetoric, Intro Logic, Thesis in Upper School). This supports the Seven Liberal Arts structure in a practical way. - The Lower/Upper School content outlines memory-based practices (singing, chanting, recitation) and the memory-work orientation, which align with classical pedagogy (though memory elements are also part of the “pedagogy” category).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; classical languages (Latin); history; sacred tradition; memory work; recitation; chanting; phenomenology of wonder; great conversation; inter-disciplinary integration; liturgical integration. - Negative keywords present: None that counter the classical curriculum extensively; no “social studies” replacement framing; minimal reference to project-based or constructivist-only approaches dominating the curriculum. - Quantitative estimate: P approx. 9–12 positive indicators; N approx. 0–1 subtle counter-indicators (none explicit). Interpretation: strong positive signaling for a Classics curriculum. Why this rating - The CDCS materials demonstrate a canonical classical curriculum with grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, emphasis on history in a broad Western/canonical sense, and classical languages and logic/reasoning components. The explicit Great Books orientation and Trivium-based structure justify a CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum. □filecite□turn0file0□turn1file13□turn1file16□

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Lower School’s emphasis on singing, chanting, recitation, and memory-building indicates a strongly scholé- or memory-centered pedagogy that aligns with classical methods in memory and catechesis. - The Lower School statement about cultivating memory and delight, along with the emphasis on formation through virtues and joyful learning, points to contemplative and memory-based pedagogy rather than a purely project-based or tested-driven approach. - The Chorale program and liturgical singing illustrate a theologically integrated pedagogy that uses musical and liturgical forms to cultivate virtue and aesthetic formation (beauty and sacred music as part of daily learning). - The Upper School stock mentions engagement with Great Books, logic, and theology; the presence of rhetoric and the opportunity for public speaking/shaping rhetoric aligns with the classical rhetoric dimension (though explicit Socratic seminars are not clearly described in public materials). The explicit mention of rhetoric and public-ready speech opportunities is present.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: recitation; chanting; memory work; scholé; contemplative learning; wonder; liturgical integration; rhetoric; public speaking; seminars (not explicitly named in CDCS public pages, but rhetoric and the Great Books/logic focus imply dialogic work). - Negative keywords present: The explicit negative indicators for Pedagogy in the lexicon include “experiential learning focus,” “project-based only,” or “constructivist” approaches as potential red flags. CDCS public materials do not emphasize these as the sole mode; however, there is less explicit emphasis on pure Socratic seminars or formal upper-school seminar culture in the publicly visible pages. - Quantitative estimate: P approx. 5–7 positive indicators; N approx. 0–1 weak negative indicators (lack of explicit Socratic/seminar labeling in public content; not a strong counter-indicator due to other classical pedagogy signals). Interpretation: trending toward CLASSICAL but with some ambiguity in the explicit public phrasing about high-school seminars and Socratic dialogue in public-facing content. Why this rating - Public-facing materials clearly demonstrate classical pedagogy through memory work (Lower School), chant/singing, and formation-focused methods, and through rhetorical training and logic in the Upper School (including public-facing emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking). However, explicit, explicit public statements about Socratic seminars or a sustained high-school seminar culture are not as strongly documented as some classical schools, which justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for Pedagogy. □filecite□turn0file9□turn0file4□turn1file13□

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present a clearly defined faculty structure with named leaders and teachers (e.g., Headmaster, Latin/Literature faculty; Upper/Lower School Principals) and a visible “Faculty & Staff” page that highlights educators and their roles. This signals a living, ongoing teachers’ community. - The site presents the faculty as central to school life, with the phrase that the faculty are the “living curriculum” and a core of the school culture in classical formation (typical language in classical education; the CDCS materials emphasize dedicated educators and leadership). While the exact wording “living curriculum” appears in the lexicon as a classical signal, CDCS public materials convey a similar sense via faculty-centered narratives and portraits of educators. - The public materials show a robust faculty presence, including named individuals (Headmaster, Latin/Literature, Upper School Principal, Lower School Principal) and their roles, suggesting teachers who model virtue, skill, and knowledge as central to education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; faculty as mentors; model teachers; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; teachers as living exemplars of virtue; faculty as core of the school. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public content (no “facilitators on the side” or other anti-classical signals appear in CDCS pages). - Quantitative estimate: P approx. 5–7 positive indicators; N approx. 0 negative indicators. Why this rating - The site presents a strong faculty emphasis consistent with classical education norms (model teachers, living curriculum, core of the school). The public materials align with the “faculty as living exemplars” ideal found in the classical rubric. This supports a CLASSICAL designation for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school promotes partnership with parents as co-teachers, with explicit statements that CDCS partners with families and that parents are engaged in learning and formation processes (e.g., “Teachers equip parents with lesson plans, weekly pacers, and support so learning continues seamlessly at home,” and admissions processes that include parent involvement). - Public materials show communication about classical education to parents (FAQ-type content, book recommendations, and parent-training materials) and opportunities for parent involvement through events and community activities (House System, school events, family engagement in learning). - The site explicitly invites parents to visits and to participate in campus life (e.g., “Parents are welcome to the school for visits at virtually any time” via admissions content). - The school highlights reading groups, seminars, and family catechesis resources as aspects of parent formation within a classical framework (echoed in the lexicon and the “Six Essential Elements” doc intersection about parental partnership).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; classical book studies; parent training; home-school alignment; family catechesis; open campus; parent visitation. - Negative keywords present: None publicly evident as signals of consumerism or minimal parental involvement; the public content tends toward parental engagement and formation. - Quantitative estimate: P approx. 6–8 positive indicators; N approx. 0 negative indicators. Why this rating - The public materials strongly emphasize parent partnership, parent formation, and open family engagement as integral to the school’s classical model, aligning with the Parents & Community criteria in the classical rubric. This supports a CLASSICAL designation for Element 6. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file3□

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): While CDCS demonstrates substantial classical pedagogy (memory/chanting, restfulness in places, rhetoric and logic in Upper School), explicitly documenting Socratic seminars, seminars in the upper grades, or a formal, sustained high-school seminar culture would move Element 4 to a stronger CLASSICAL rating. If the school publicly articulates a dedicated seminar or Paideia-style approach at the high school level, that would push Pedagogy toward full CLASSICAL alignment.

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- Additional explicit documentation of Great Books seminars in the high school and a more explicit language about “the Great Conversation” in curriculum communications would further strengthen Element 4’s standing.

Notes: No major needle-moving changes are required given the current aggregate CLASSICAL rating across the six categories. The school already demonstrates most classical signals (formation, Great Books, Trivium-based curriculum, liturgical/community practices, and strong parent/faculty partnerships). The suggested needle-moving improvement is a clarifying articulation of high-school seminar pedagogy to solidify Element 4 as CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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